

Μόλπις ὁ Ἐλεάτης

Molpis of Elea on Spartan Customs and Cuisine

eul_aid: aic

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Ἰωνική [Ionic \(frg\)](#)
Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)
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Molpis of Elea was a 6th-century BCE historian from the Greek colony of Elea in southern Italy. His dating is based on the colony's foundation around 540/535 BCE. Beyond his name, origin, and classification as a writer of history, no biographical details survive.

His sole known work is the lost *Founding of Elea*, cited only once by Athenaeus. That citation preserves Molpis's record that the city's founders, the Phocaeans, initially called it "Hyele". No other fragments exist.

Molpis was a local historian, or *kitsiologos*, chronicling his city's origins. His significance lies in being one of the earliest attested historians of Magna Graecia. His work, however, appears to have had minimal circulation or influence, and he remains a minor figure in the fragmentary record of pre-Herodotean historiography.

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